2.24 Legion Units. This period of history finds the legion—and the units that make up its maniples—in transition, both in terms of what the men fought with and how the units were used. For example, it appears that the change from spears to throwing javelins (pila) for the bulk of legionary infantry was not abrupt. Nor was it total. Thus, you find references to some Principes units with pila and some with spears. Certainly, by the time of Scipio—and then Marius and Caesar—the Principes had become virtually indistinguishable from the Hastati. And then there's the question of Roman cavalry. Polybius says they were armed in the "Greek" style, which would make them heavy cavalry; however, Polybius also points out that they were armed only with small shields and spears—not exactly heavy cavalry. To say that hundreds of historians have taken a crack at this question is to understate the situation. Our counter-mix provides you, the player, with what we feel to be the most applicable unit types. If your most recent archaeological trip to Etruria has revealed something different, feel free to adjust.